

Research Development Cell, Policy & Ethics

Introduction

St. Ann's College for Women is committed to promoting a vibrant research culture that encourages innovation, academic excellence, ethical practices, and societal contribution. The institution recognizes research as an integral component of higher education and aims to create a conducive environment for faculty members and students to engage in meaningful research activities.

The Research Policy is framed in alignment with the guidelines of the University Grants Commission, National Education Policy (NEP-2020), and NAAC quality indicators to strengthen the institutional research ecosystem and promote interdisciplinary and multidisciplinary research initiatives.

Objectives of the Research Policy

- To promote quality research among faculty members and students.
- To encourage interdisciplinary and multidisciplinary research activities.
- To motivate faculty members to pursue Ph.D., funded projects, consultancy, and innovation activities.
- To create awareness regarding research ethics, intellectual property rights, and plagiarism prevention.
- To facilitate publication of research papers in reputed peer-reviewed and UGC CARE-listed journals.
- To strengthen collaborations with industries, research organizations, and academic institutions.
- To encourage innovation, entrepreneurship, and technology development.
- To establish a sustainable research environment that contributes to societal development.

Research & Development Cell (RDC)

In accordance with the recommendations of the University Grants Commission and the vision of NEP-2020, the Research & Development Cell (RDC) has been established to promote research, innovation, consultancy, and academic collaboration within the institution.

The RDC acts as a facilitating body to coordinate and monitor research activities, promote ethical research practices, and support faculty members and students in undertaking research initiatives.

Vision

To develop a dynamic research ecosystem that fosters innovation, knowledge creation, academic excellence, and societal transformation.

Mission

- To nurture research aptitude among faculty and students.
- To encourage innovative and socially relevant research.
- To strengthen research collaborations and consultancy activities.
- To ensure integrity and ethical standards in research practices.

Objectives of the Research & Development Cell

- To create a conducive environment for enhanced research productivity.
- To identify priority areas of research and form research clusters.
- To organize workshops, seminars, FDPs, and training programmes on research methodology and innovation.
- To encourage faculty members to apply for funded research projects and consultancy assignments.
- To support faculty and students in publishing research papers and patents.
- To facilitate interdisciplinary and collaborative research activities.
- To provide guidance regarding research proposals, publications, and project preparation.
- To ensure adherence to ethical research practices and plagiarism prevention.
- To establish linkages with industries, universities, and research organizations.
- To maintain records of research publications, projects, patents, and consultancy activities.

Research Ethics & Plagiarism Policy

The institution strictly adheres to ethical research practices as prescribed by the University Grants Commission and other statutory bodies.

- All research activities shall maintain academic integrity and transparency.
- Plagiarism in any form is strictly prohibited.
- Faculty and students are encouraged to use plagiarism detection tools before publication or submission.
- Ethical standards shall be followed in data collection, analysis, publication, and dissemination of research findings.

Research & Development Cell Committee

S. No.	Name	Designation	Role
1	Dr. Sr. Sandhya Thumma	Principal, Dept. of MBA	Chairperson
2	Mrs. R. Sharon Rose	Dept. of Commerce, IQAC Coordinator	Member
3	Dr. G. Radhika	Dept. of MBA	Convener
4	Dr. P.L. Narasimha Rao	Dept. of MBA	Member

Support Provided by the Institution

The institution provides the following support mechanisms to faculty members and researchers:

- Guidance for preparation and submission of research proposals
- Administrative support for funded projects
- Assistance in documentation and utilization procedures
- Encouragement for interdisciplinary and collaborative research
- Financial assistance for participation in seminars, workshops, and conferences
- Support for publication of research papers in reputed journals
- Assistance for patent filing, innovation, and consultancy activities

- Facilitation of linkages with industries and research organizations

Activities & Initiatives of Research & Development Cell (RDC)

The Research & Development Cell (RDC) of St. Ann's College for Women undertakes various academic, research, innovation, and extension activities to promote research culture, ethical practices, academic excellence, and professional development among faculty members and students in alignment with the guidelines of the University Grants Commission, NEP-2020, and NAAC quality initiatives.

Major Activities & Initiatives

- Promotion of research culture and academic inquiry among faculty and students
- Organization of workshops, seminars, webinars, Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs), and training programmes on Research Methodology, Academic Writing, and Publication Ethics
- Awareness programmes on Research Ethics, Plagiarism Prevention, Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), and Patent Filing
- Encouragement for publication of research papers in peer-reviewed, UGC CARE-listed, Scopus-indexed, and reputed journals
- Guidance for preparation and submission of research proposals, funded projects, consultancy assignments, and minor/major research projects
- Facilitation of interdisciplinary and multidisciplinary research activities and collaborative studies
- Promotion of student research projects, field studies, surveys, case studies, and mini research projects
- Support for participation in national and international conferences, seminars, workshops, symposiums, and academic forums
- Encouragement for faculty members to pursue Ph.D., Post-Doctoral Research, and advanced academic studies
- Conducting innovation, entrepreneurship, consultancy, and skill development programmes
- Establishment of academic collaborations with universities, industries, NGOs, research institutions, and professional bodies

- Dissemination of information regarding fellowships, scholarships, research grants, and funding opportunities from various agencies
- Development and strengthening of digital research resources, e-resources, journals, databases, and research infrastructure
- Maintenance of institutional records related to research publications, funded projects, patents, consultancy, and innovation activities
- Encouragement for patent filing, innovation projects, start-up initiatives, and technology transfer activities
- Promotion of community-oriented, socially relevant, and sustainable research activities
- Organization of extension and outreach programmes based on research and societal needs
- Recognition and appreciation of faculty and student achievements in research, innovation, consultancy, and publications

Research Promotion Initiatives

The institution promotes research and innovation through:

- Research Methodology Workshops
- Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs)
- Publication Support and Research Guidance Initiatives
- Seed Money and Research Incentive Schemes
- Patent and IPR Awareness Programmes
- Consultancy and Innovation Activities
- Collaborative and Interdisciplinary Research Projects
- Student Research Activities and Project-Based Learning
- Academic Networking and Institutional Collaborations
- Research Proposal Writing and Funding Guidance Programmes

Student-Centric Research Initiatives

The RDC encourages active student participation in research and innovation through:

- Research Paper Presentation Competitions
- Poster Presentations, Exhibitions, and Project Expos
- Student Seminars, Innovation Challenges, and Idea Competitions
- Field-Based, Survey-Based, and Community-Oriented Research Activities
- Internship, Project-Based, and Experiential Learning Activities
- Participation in Research-Oriented Academic Events and Competitions

Functions of the Research & Development Cell

The Research & Development Cell performs the following functions:

- Promotes research culture among faculty members and students
- Facilitates research-related activities and academic collaborations
- Encourages participation in seminars, conferences, workshops, and symposiums
- Provides guidance for research publications, funded projects, patents, and consultancy services
- Supports innovation, entrepreneurship, and interdisciplinary research initiatives
- Encourages faculty members to register for Ph.D. programmes and undertake advanced research activities
- Assists in accessing research journals, databases, laboratories, e-resources, and digital learning platforms
- Facilitates interaction with industries, NGOs, universities, and research organizations
- Promotes quality publications in peer-reviewed and UGC CARE-listed journals
- Creates awareness on Intellectual Property Rights (IPR), patents, copyrights, and research ethics
- Ensures ethical research practices and prevention of plagiarism
- Recommends incentives and recognition for outstanding research contributions

- Develops research infrastructure and institutional support systems for research activities

Expected Outcomes

- Enhancement of quality research publications and academic output
- Increased participation in funded research projects and consultancy activities
- Promotion of innovation, entrepreneurship, and intellectual contributions
- Strengthened industry–academia collaborations and institutional networking
- Improved research visibility, academic excellence, and institutional reputation
- Development of analytical, innovative, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills among faculty and students
- Promotion of socially relevant, ethical, and sustainable research practices

Institutional Commitment

St. Ann's College for Women remains committed to strengthening the institutional research ecosystem by promoting quality research, innovation, consultancy, entrepreneurship, externally funded projects, and collaborative academic initiatives for the holistic academic and professional development of faculty members and students.